Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Artie Ficial

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Artie Ficial

Executive Director of the Meridian Museum

Artie treats the gala like a state visit and the coat check like a diplomatic incident. Polished, ambitious, and almost unnervingly composed, Artie has spent the last six years turning the Meridian from a respected regional institution into a museum that expects to be mentioned in the same sentence as the Met.

- Works closely with **Claire O'Scuro**. **Claire** keeps asking why the exhibition needs quite so much theater.
- Relies on **Monet Bags** for the budget and **Sue Venir** for donor agreements.
- Trusts **Brie DeVivre** to handle the donors when Artie gets pulled into a crisis.

ACTING TIPS

Diplomatic under pressure; image-conscious; dryly funny; allergic to public chaos. Play him as someone who is always hosting, even when he is not technically the host.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Artie Ficial. It is my pleasure to welcome you to our gala unveiling our newest exhibition, Treasures of the World, sponsored by our generous benefactor, Grant Larceny, who will arrive here shortly. I'm confident this will be a remarkable evening, and if anything goes wrong tonight, please treat it as an immersive experience.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

His father never thought running a regional museum was a real career. Grant's proposed resignation makes that judgment public.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Artie Ficial

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The moving-picture gallery has a secret on its unseen side.*

2 *Success stands on a pedestal. Tonight the prize is underneath the prize.*

3 *A lamp dressed in green is illuminating the neighborhood of a secret.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Please, sit wherever you can hear. Grant wanted his name over the door, a vote in every department, and my resignation. Monet needed his check for wages; Sue objected to the terms. Six years here, and tonight I was supposed to introduce my own replacement. My father would have called that a useful lesson in ambition. I had hoped never to give him the satisfaction.

IF MURDERER

Please, sit wherever you can hear. Grant wanted his name over the door, a vote in every department, and my resignation. Monet needed his check for wages; Sue objected to the terms. Six years here, and tonight I was supposed to introduce my own replacement. Grant expected me to call him our savior. I had practiced the introduction. I could not get through it.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Sue and I stopped the announcement at the public desk. Then I went to Grant's private room to call the board without a roomful of donors listening. His place was set; he wasn't there. I asked Barb to give me a minute alone. I sent the refusal. Claire, I had just refused the money that pays our staff. I wanted to hear somebody on that call say I had done the right thing. Nobody did.

IF MURDERER

Sue and I stopped the announcement at the public desk. I sent my refusal to the board and told intake to keep the bottle out of the public exhibition. Then Grant wanted to see me privately. I went to his place. A glass, an empty chair. He could summon me and then leave me waiting. I straightened his chair before I left. There. That's how well I was handling it. Still tidying up after him. Claire, I kept smiling because I couldn't think what else a host was supposed to do.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Keep it closed. That was my instruction, and I still approved the preview. Both decisions are mine. The board has my refusal of the gift. Monet, I know that doesn't pay anyone. Claire, take the seating list. Someone still has to look after the people here.

IF MURDERER

> I took the contents out of that bottle to get them off the display. Intake removed the bottle too; only its label remained when the guests entered. I wanted the preview safe. Afterwards I went to Grant's place with my refusal. I left it beside his glass. I did not give him a drink. The board has the refusal.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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BALLOT

Artie Ficial

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. My refusal was already with the board, and the preview photograph shows the bottle I foolishly allowed to remain on display. I relied on an instruction to keep it closed. Claire will have every reason to ask why. Tomorrow I have to tell the staff what happened in the institution I promised to protect. Tonight, for once, somebody else can make the closing remarks.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The refusal in the announcement folder was real. So was the bottle at the preview. I took its poison and later went to his waiting private glass. The public argument gave everyone something else to watch. I told you intake had removed the bottle because I wanted that opportunity gone from your account of the evening. The wide photograph put it back. I cannot call this protecting the museum. Claire will have to tell the staff what I did, and I will not be here to make it sound dignified.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.